What Is MCP?

The Model Context Protocol, from the source

What can an AI app reach?

MCP

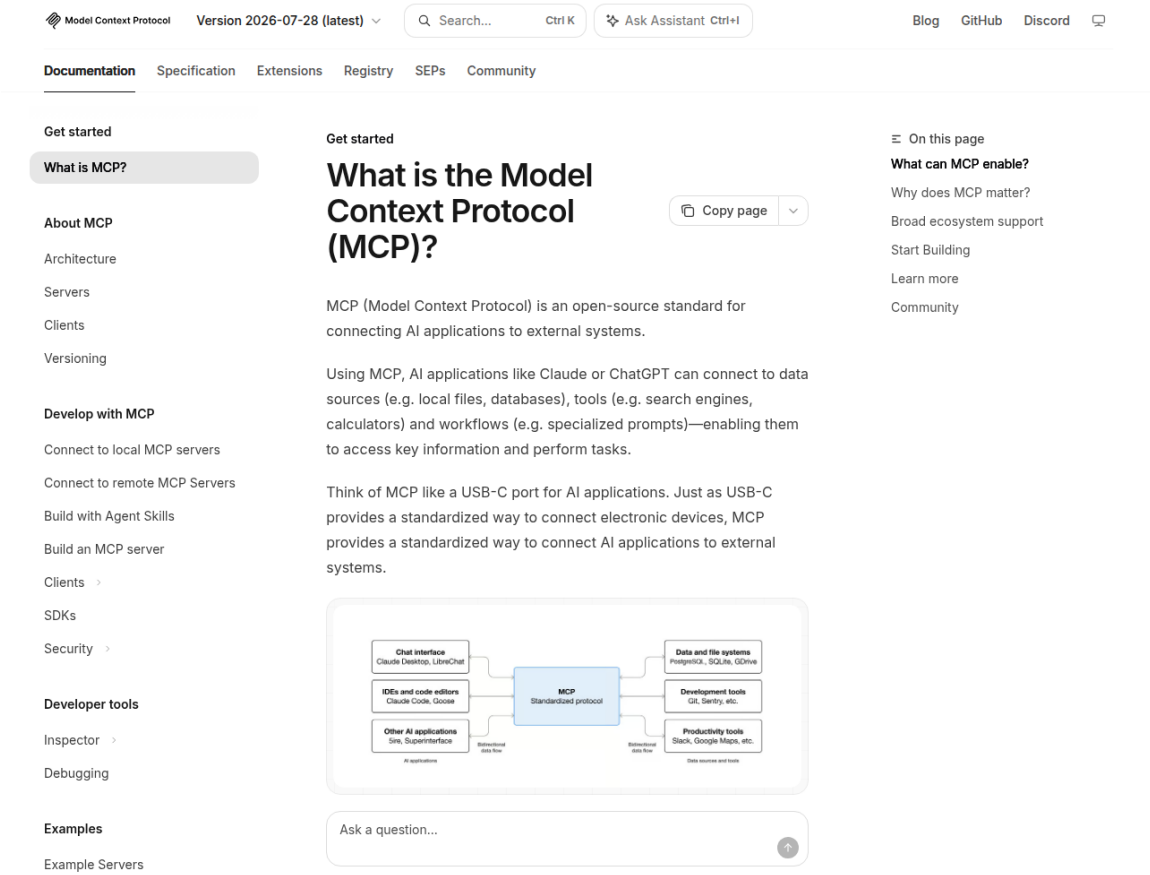
An open standard for connecting AI apps to systems

The Official Analogy

A USB-C port for AI

One plug, many devices

One protocol, many tools



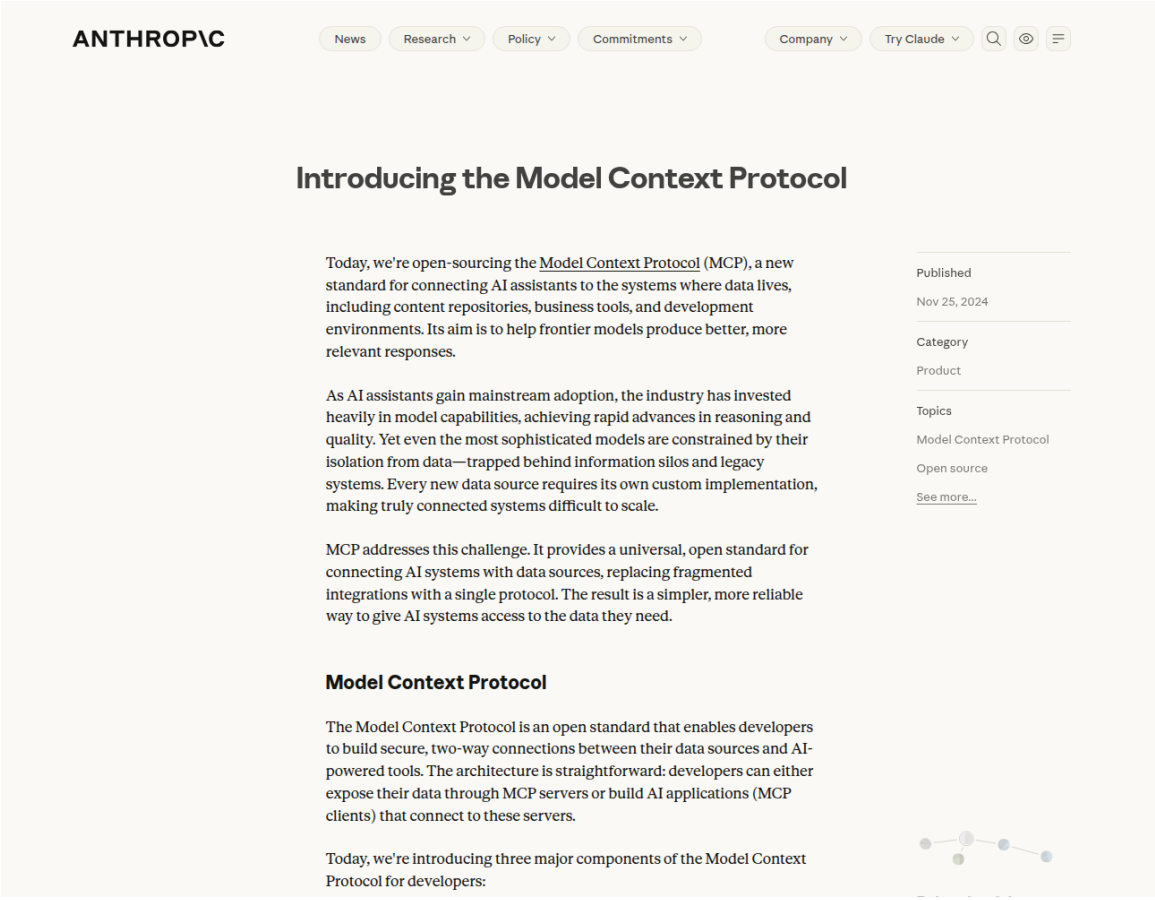
[Source]

Where It Came From

Anthropic, November 2024

Open source from day one

Replaced one-off links



Source

Three Participants

Host

The AI app, such as Claude Code

Client

One connection to one server

Server

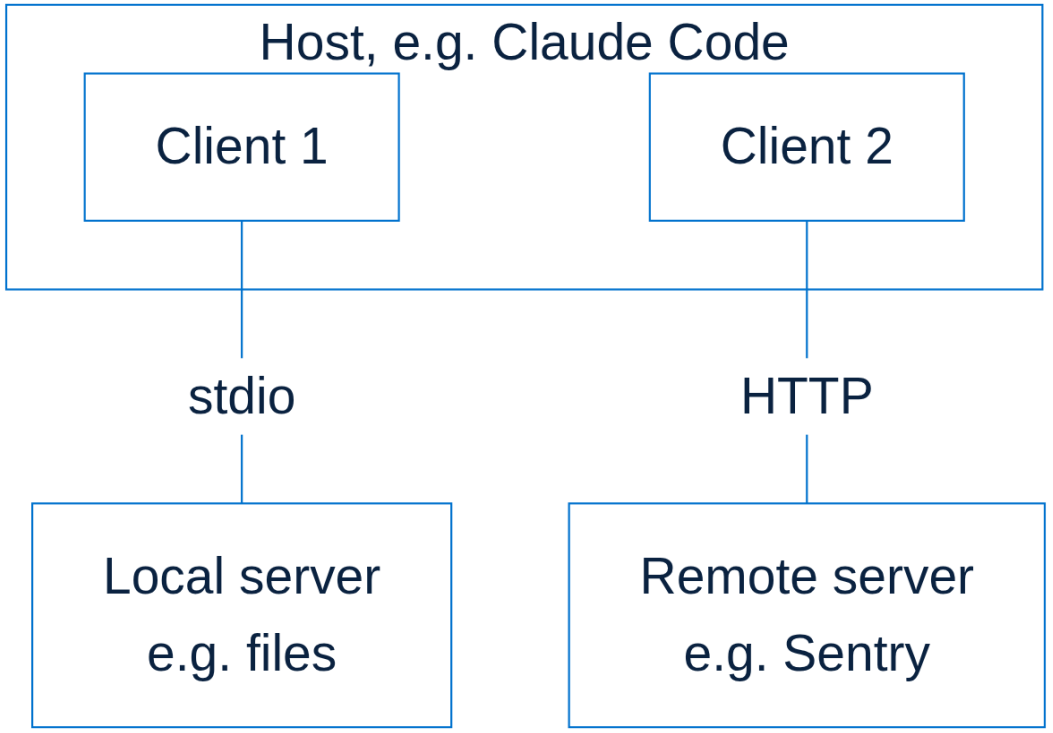
A program that offers context

How They Connect

One client per server

Local servers use stdio

Remote servers use HTTP



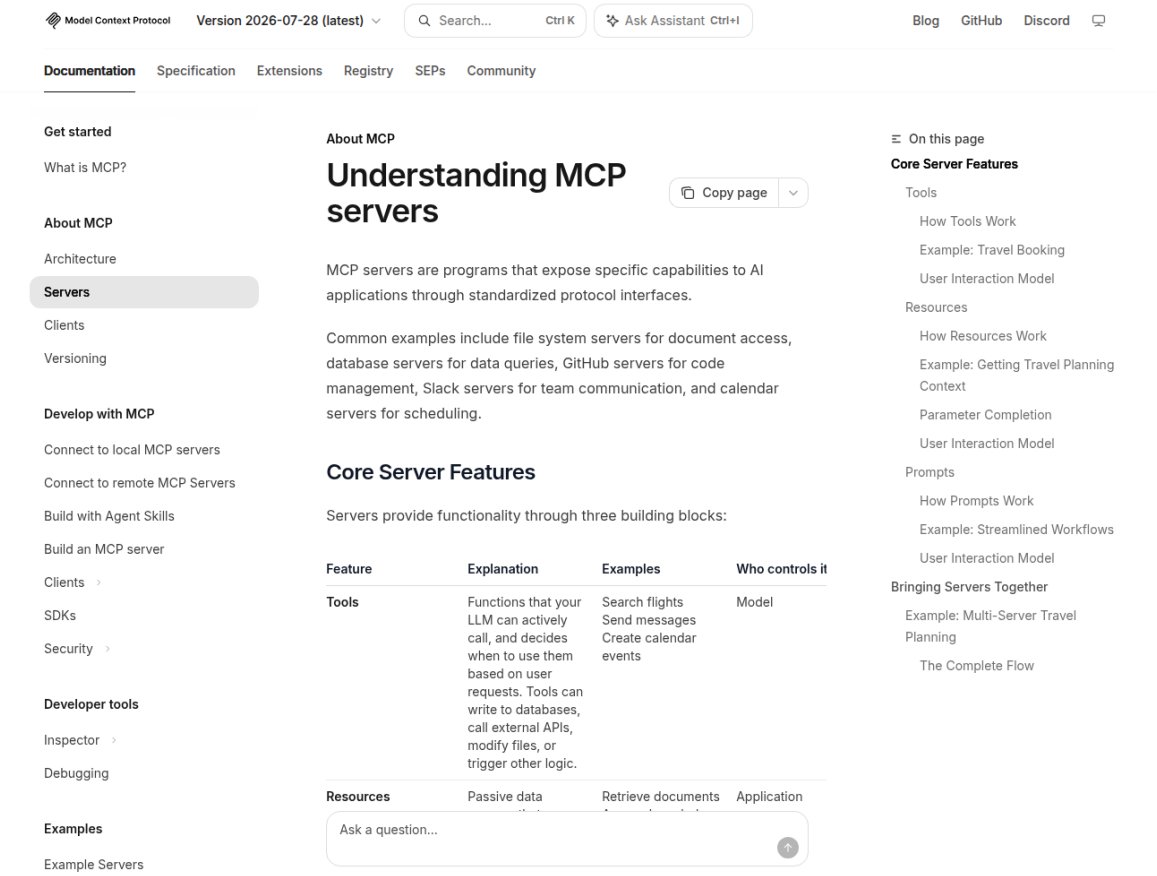
Source

What a Server Offers

Tools: actions to take

Resources: data to read

Prompts: ready templates



Source

Who Controls Each One

Feature	Controlled by	Example
Tools	The model	Search flights
Resources	The application	Read a calendar
Prompts	The user	Plan a vacation

One Tool Call, Step by Step

01 Discover

The app asks the server for its tools

02 Decide

The model picks one for the task

03 Call

The server runs it and sends back a result

What Travels Between Them

JSON-RPC 2.0 messages

Each request carries the version

Servers say what they support

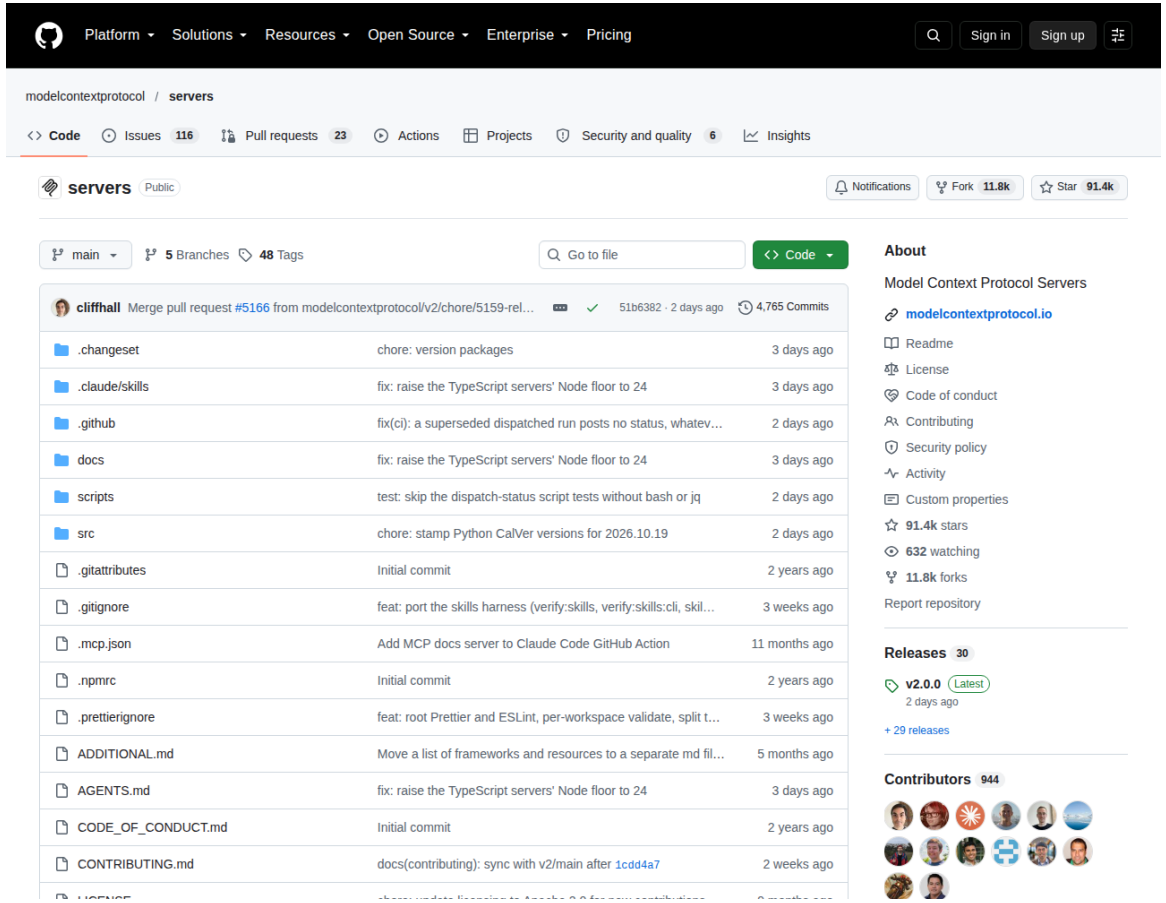
Same format, local or remote

Ready-Made Servers

Open-source examples

91.4k stars on GitHub

Start from one of these



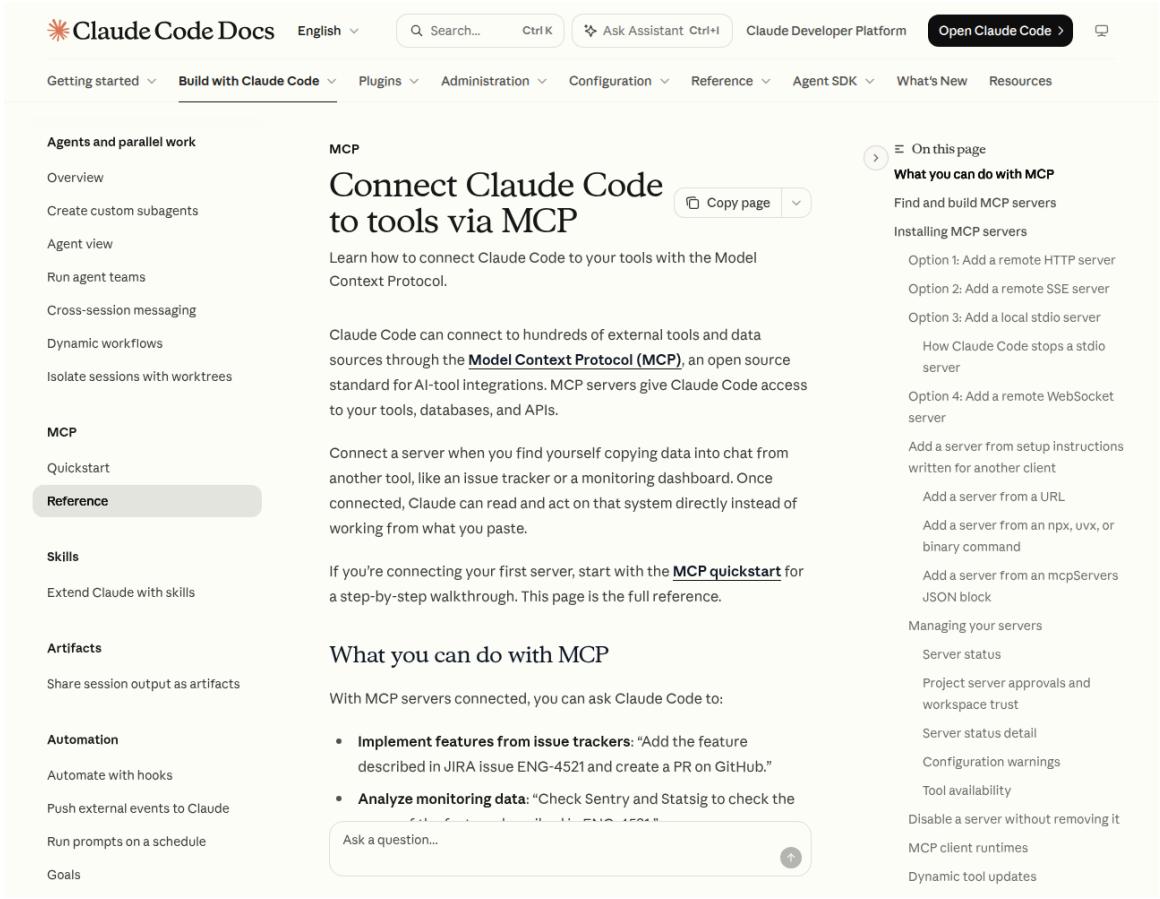
[Source]

Using It From Claude Code

Hundreds of tools

Connect, then just ask

Documented by Anthropic



Source

Adding a Server

To do this	Use
Add a server	claude mcp add
See your servers	claude mcp list
Remote, e.g. Notion	--transport http
Local, e.g. Airtable	--transport stdio

Use It Safely

Only connect servers you trust

Fetched content can carry instructions

Approve tool calls you did not expect

A local server runs with your access

What MCP Is, and Is Not

It is	It is not
A protocol for context	An AI model
Open source	An app you install
The same for every app	A rule for using models

Your First Ten Minutes

01 Pick a server you trust

Start from the reference list

02 Add it to your host

In Claude Code, claude mcp add

03 Ask for something it does

And approve the tool call

Sources, Captured 21 Oct 2026

Slide	Taken from
Analogy, architecture	modelcontextprotocol.io
Server features	modelcontextprotocol.io
Announcement	anthropic.com/news
Reference servers	github.com
Claude Code	code.claude.com/docs

What would you connect?